📖 1. Series Overview

The **Windows Fundamentals** pathway on TryHackMe is a deep dive into the most widely used operating system in the corporate world. This series covers everything from basic UI navigation to advanced system configuration, registry manipulation, and security auditing.

🖥️ Part 1: The Basics & Desktop Navigation

In the first part, I explored the user-facing side of Windows and the essential built-in tools for basic management.

🛠️ Core Tools Mastered:

- **Task Manager:** Monitoring CPU, Memory, and Disk usage to identify system bottlenecks.
- **System Configuration (msconfig):** Managing "Boot" options and "Services" that start automatically.
- **Control Panel vs. Settings:** Understanding where to find legacy hardware settings vs. modern UI configurations.

ANSWERS:

Task 2

What encryption can you enable on Pro that you can't enable in Home?

BitLocker

Task 3

Which selection will hide/disable the Search box?

Hidden

Which selection will hide/disable the Task View button?

Show task view button

Besides Clock and Network, what other icon is visible in the Notification Area?

Action Center

Task 4

What is the meaning of NTFS?

New Technology File System

Task 5

What is the system variable for the Windows folder?

%windir%

Task 6

What is the name of the other user account?

tryhackmebilly

What groups is this user a member of?

Remote Desktop Users, Users

What built-in account is for guest access to the computer?

Guest

What is the account description?

window$Fun1!

Task 7

What does UAC mean?

User Account Control

Task 8

In the Control Panel, change the view to ***Small icons****. What is the last setting in the Control Panel view?*

Windows Defender Firewall

Task 9

What is the keyboard shortcut to open Task Manager?

Ctrl+Shift+Esc

⚙️ Part 2: System Configuration & The Registry

Part 2 focuses on the "under the hood" components that power the operating system.

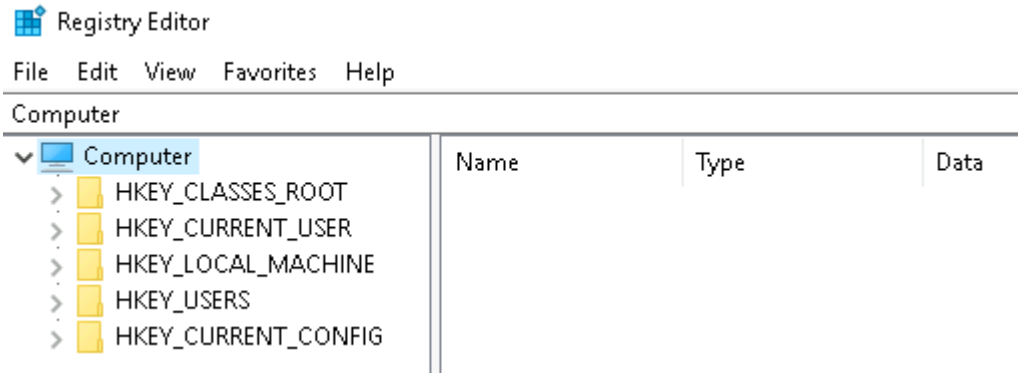
🔑 The Windows Registry (regedit)

The Registry is a massive database that stores settings for the OS and applications. I learned about the five main hives:

1. **HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT:** File associations.
2. **HKEY_CURRENT_USER:** Settings for the logged-in user.
3. **HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE (HKLM):** Settings for the entire computer (most important for security).
4. **HKEY_USERS:** Profiles for all users.
5. **HKEY_CURRENT_CONFIG:** Hardware profile information.

🛠️ Administrative Tools:

- **Computer Management:** A "one-stop-shop" for managing local users, groups, and disks.
- **Event Viewer:** The most critical tool for defenders to find logs of failed logins or system errors.



ANSWERS:

Task 2

What is the name of the service that lists Systems Internals as the manufacturer?

PsShutdown

Whom is the Windows license registered to?

Windows User

What is the command for Windows Troubleshooting?

C:\Windows\System32\control.exe /name Microsoft.Troubleshooting

What command will open the Control Panel?

Control.exe

Task 3

What is the command to open User Account Control Settings?

UserAccountControlSettings.exe

Task 4

What is the command to open Computer Management?

compmgmt.msc

At what time every day is the GoogleUpdateTaskMachineUA task configured to run?

6:15 AM

What is the name of the hidden folder that is shared?

sh4r3dF0Ld3r

Task 5

What is the command to open System Information?

msinfo32.exe

What is listed under System Name?

THM-WINFUN2

Under Environment Variables, what is the value for ComSpec?

%SystemRoot%\system32\cmd.exe

Task 6

What is the command to open Resource Monitor?

Resmon.exe

Task 7

In System Configuration, what is the full command for Internet Protocol Configuration?

C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe /k %windir%\system32\ipconfig.exe

For the ipconfig command, how do you show detailed information?

ipconfig /all

Task 8

What is the command to open the Registry Editor?

regedt32.exe

🛡️ Part 3: Security & Advanced Administration

The final part covers how to secure a Windows environment and manage it at scale.

👮 Windows Defender & Firewall

- **Windows Security:** Managing real-time protection and virus scans.
- **Firewall with Advanced Security:** Creating "Inbound" and "Outbound" rules to block malicious traffic.

📜 Active Directory & Group Policy (GPO)

I was introduced to the concept of a **Domain Controller** and how **Group Policy Objects** are used to enforce security settings (like password complexity) across thousands of computers at once.

🐚 Introduction to PowerShell

Unlike the standard Command Prompt (CMD), **PowerShell** is a powerful task automation framework.

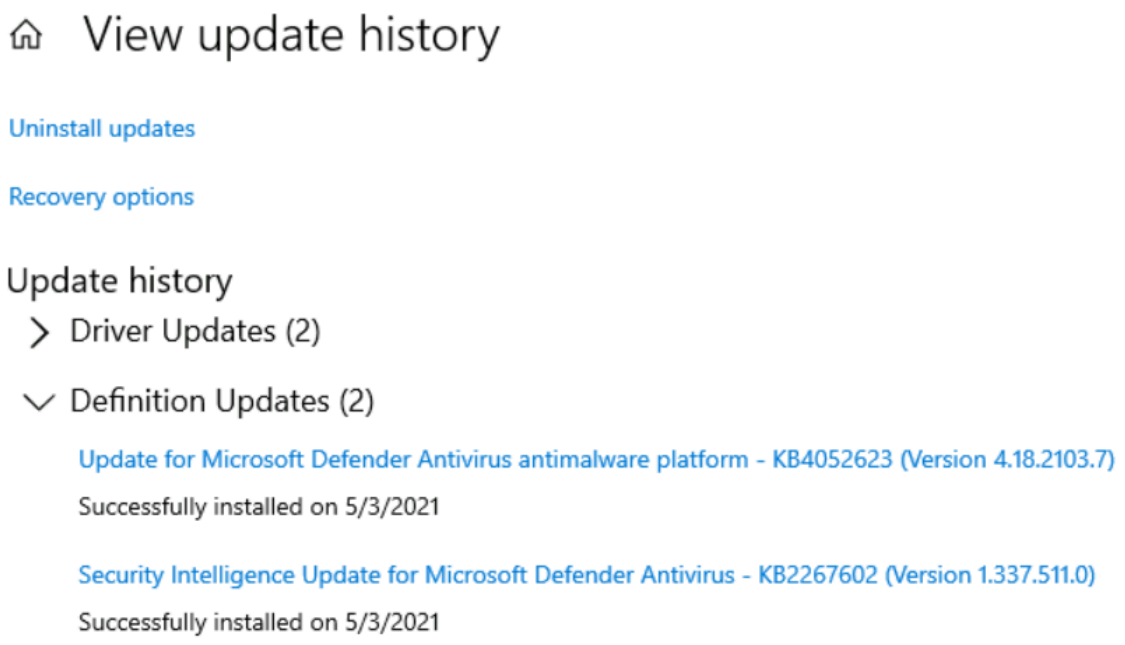
- *Key Command:* `Get-Service | Where-Object {$_.Status -eq "Running"}`

`ANSWERS:`

Task 2: Windows Update

#1. There were two definition updates installed in the attached VM. On what date were these updates installed?

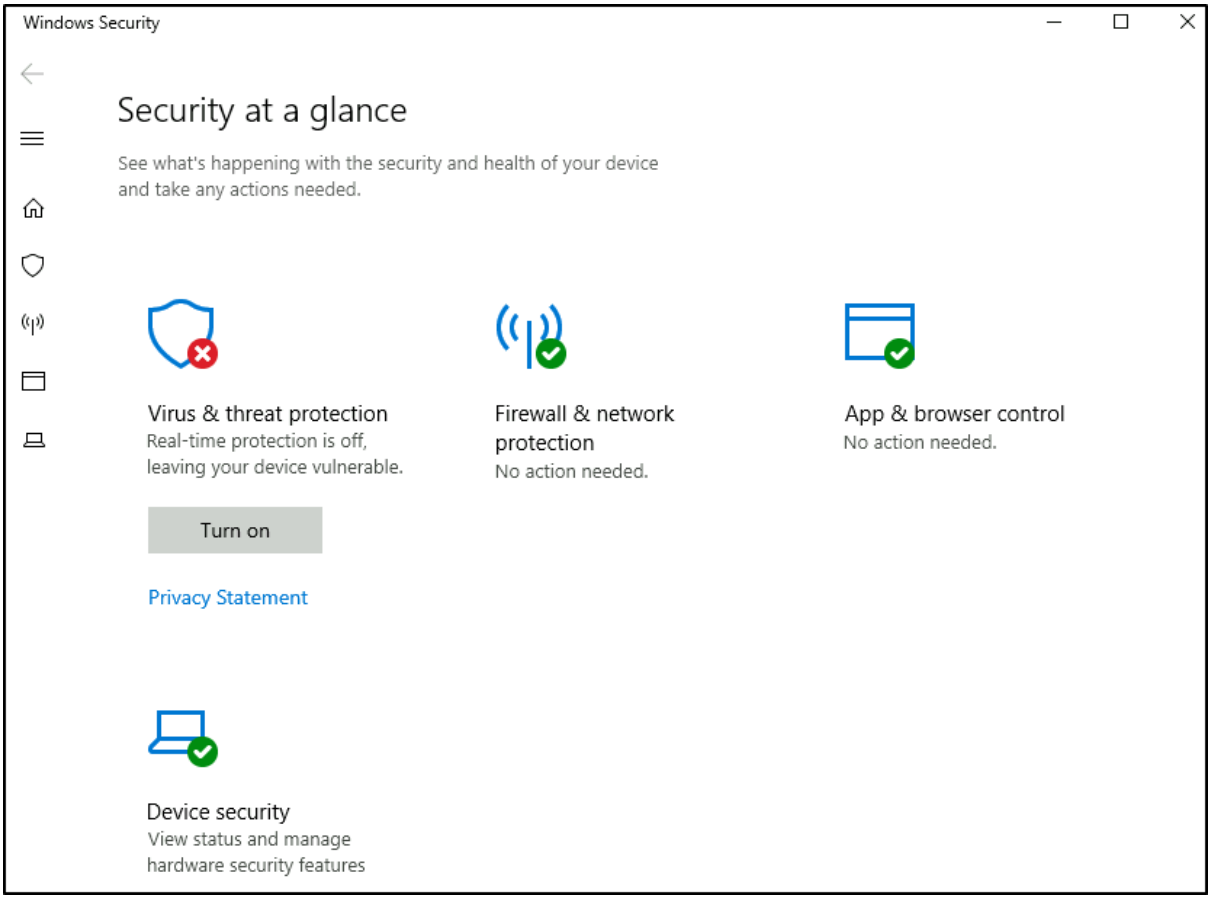
5/3/2021



Task 3: Windows Security

#1. In the above image, which area needs immediate attention?

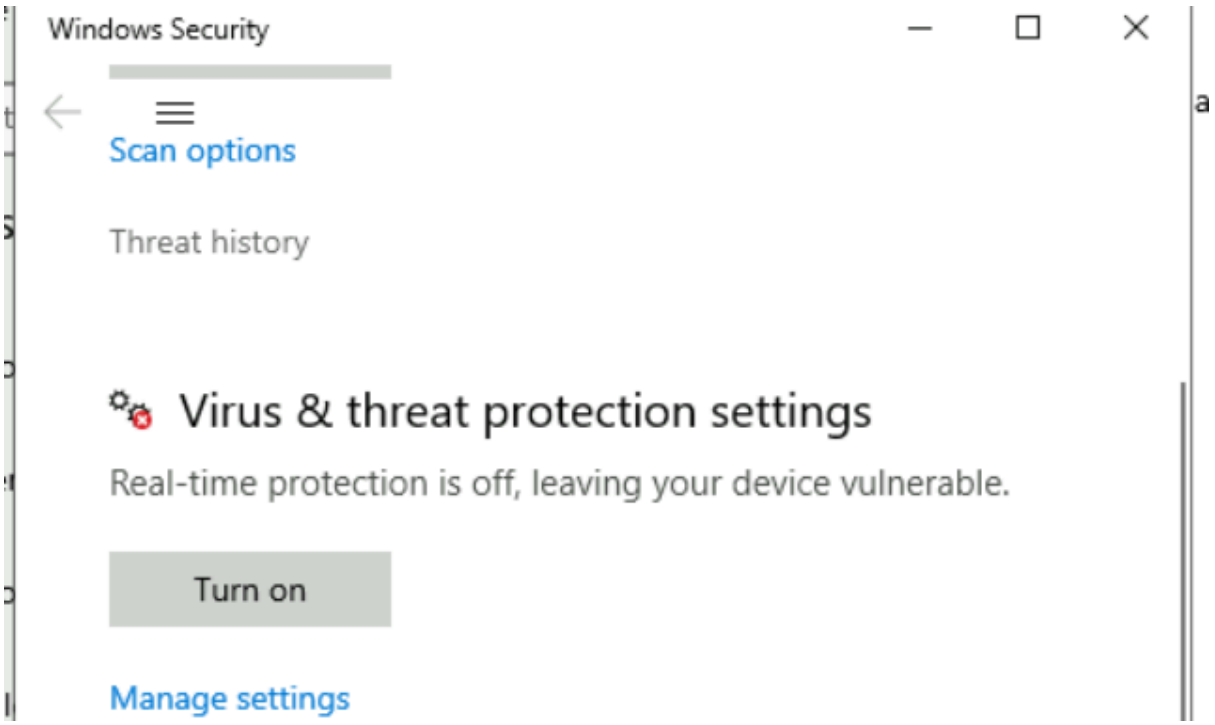
Virus & Threat protection



Task 4: Virus & Threat protection

#1. Specifically, what is turned off that Windows is notifying you to turn on?

Real-time protection



Task 5: Firewall & Network Protection

#1. If you were connected to airport Wi-Fi, what most likely will be the active firewall profile?

Public Network

Task 6: App & Browser Control

No answer needed.

Task 7: Device Security

#1. What is the TPM?

Trusted Platform Module

Task 8: Bitlocker

#1. What must a user insert on computers that **DO NOT** have a TPM version 1.2 or later?

USB startup key

System requirements

BitLocker has the following requirements:

- For BitLocker to use the system integrity check provided by a TPM, the device must have TPM 1.2 or later versions. If a device doesn't have a TPM, saving a startup key on a removable drive is mandatory when enabling BitLocker

Task 9: Volume Shadow Copy Service

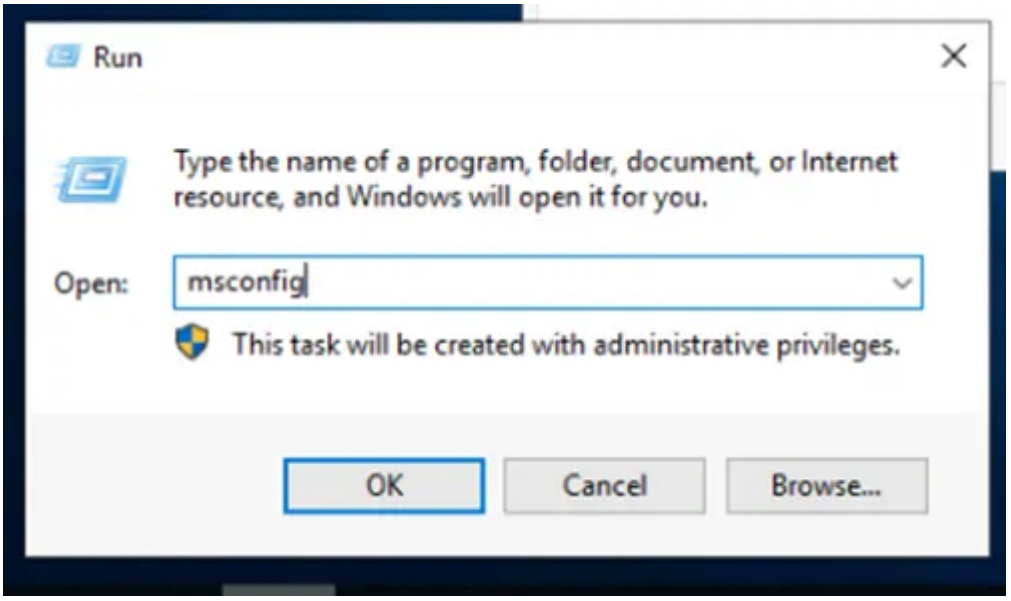
#1. What is VSS?

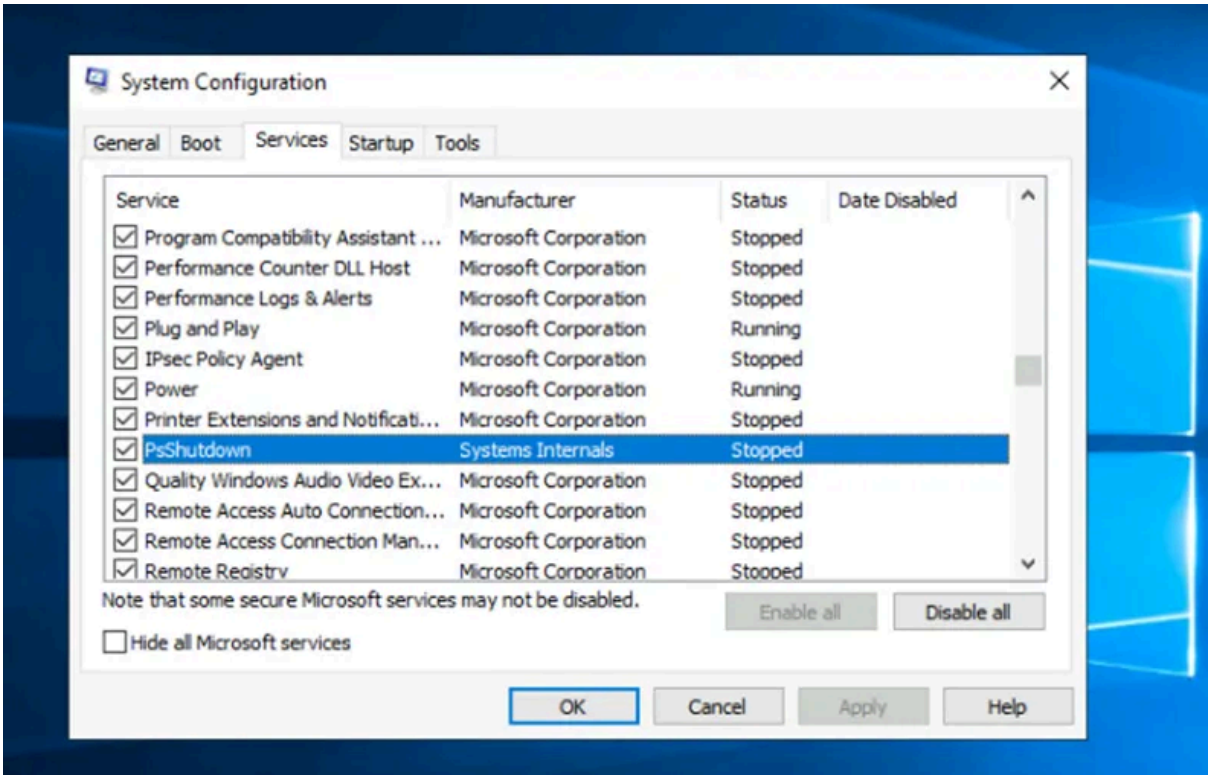
Volume Shadow Copy Service

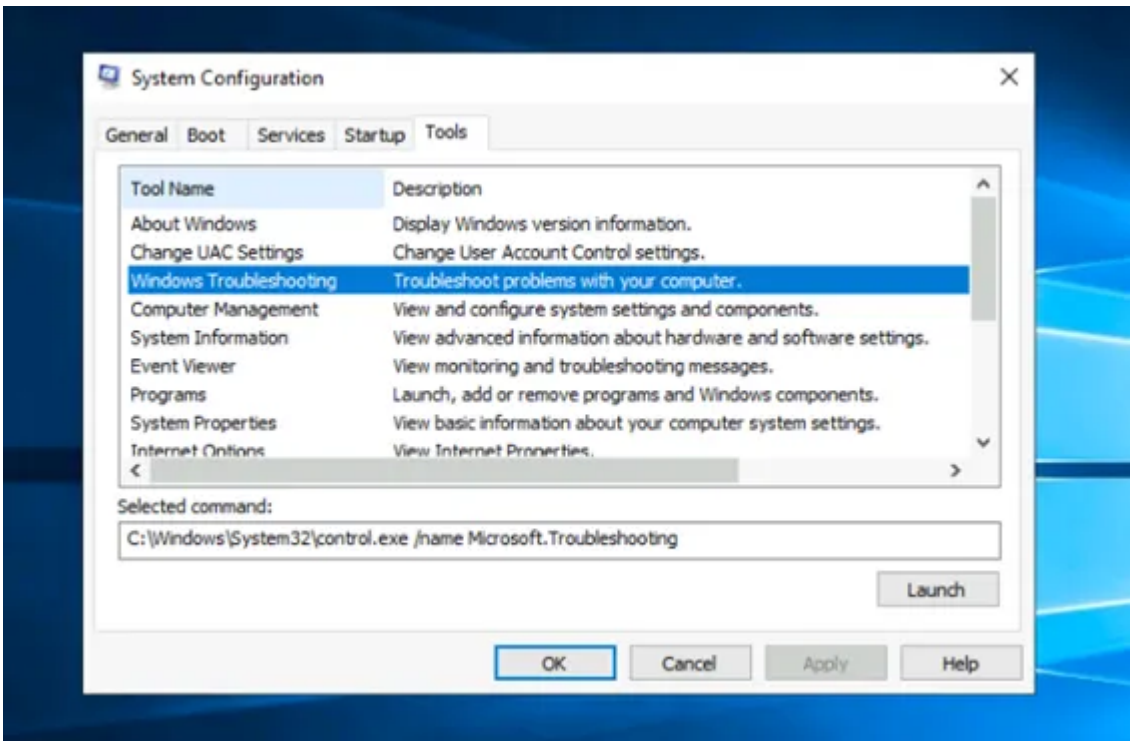
🚩 5. Lab Evidence

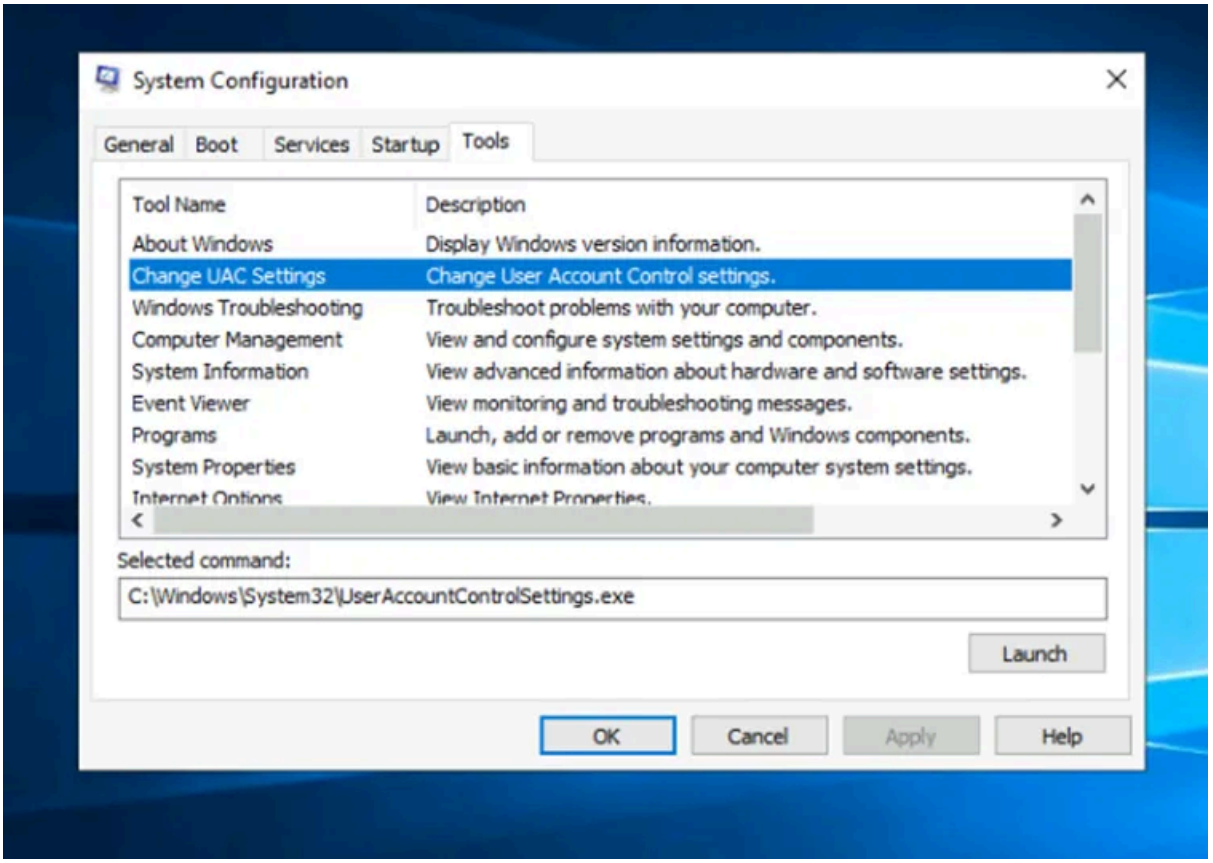
Throughout these three modules, I completed several interactive challenges to prove my Windows administration proficiency.

📸 System Admin Proof






System Configuration
General
Boot
Services
Startup
Tools
Tool Name
Description
About Windows
Display Windows version information.
Change UAC Settings
Change User Account Control settings.
Windows Troubleshooting
Troubleshoot problems with your computer.
Computer Management
View and configure system settings and components.
System Information
View advanced information about hardware and software settings.
Event Viewer
View monitoring and troubleshooting messages.
Programs
Launch, add or remove programs and Windows components.
System Properties
View basic information about your computer system settings.
Selected command:
C:\Windows\System32\control.exe /name Microsoft.Troubleshooting
Launch
OK
Cancel
Apply
Help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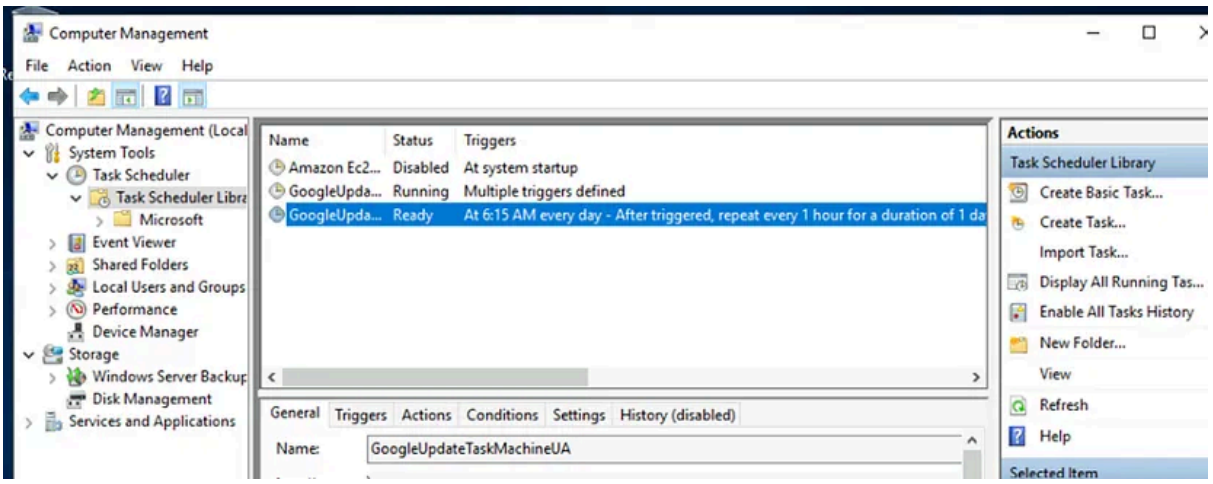

🎓 6. Conclusion & Skills Gained

By completing this series, I have built a professional foundation in:

- Navigating the **Windows File System** and Hidden Folders.
- Modifying the **Registry** to change system behaviour.
- Troubleshooting system issues using **Event Viewer and Task Manager**.
- Understanding the basics of **Active Directory** environments.